

promote your site by sending direct traffic, producing links to your site, and generating awareness.

Let's take the case of the most popular social networking tool out there Facebook. What you can do is create a fan page for your service. Ask your friends and family to change their status to promote your website or fan page. By embedding a simple code in your website you can get yourself a Facebook "like" button. This is similar to the Digg button. In fact you can use any and all of these social media services to promote your business. Let's look at forums. If you sell something for a niche market, forums are a great way of providing a space for customer interaction. This serves the dual purpose of some sort of semi-official support mechanism, as well as a great platform for very direct feedback about your products. You should register on as many tech and niche forums as possible. Once you get a bit of reputation and say you've taken up a few jobs for some of your forum members such as building small sites or registering domain names, you should immediately ask for a recommendation from them. Similarly, you should ask your clients to go and post comments on your Facebook page as testimonials.

Another aspect of this is to ask for link-backs to your website. For example if you register a domain and build a simple site for a client, you can with their permission put in a banner at the bottom of the site saying "hosting powered by" your site or "website designed by" etc. This way potential clients will click through to your site. The more the number of

